

Maximizing Driver Revenue Per Shift

Data-driven fleet strategy | 237.7M trips analyzed | NYC TLC 2023–2025

SITUATION

The NYC yellow taxi market has recovered to 48% of pre-COVID trip volume, while per-trip revenue has increased 33% following the 2023 TLC fare restructure — stabilizing at \$28.86 per trip. Despite this, significant revenue disparity exists across zones and shift windows. A driver positioned correctly earns 3x the fleet average.

KEY METRICS — 2023 TO 2025 BASELINE

	Fleet average	Best window	Uplift
Revenue per trip	\$28.86	\$85–\$89 (JFK 2pm–7pm)	+3.0x
Revenue per minute	\$1.98	\$2.57 (4am–6am)	+30%
Tip rate	19.2%	21.4% (5pm–7pm)	+11%
Avg trip duration	17 mins	43–57 mins (airport)	Longer

STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

01

Prioritize JFK during afternoon peak

Position drivers at JFK (Zone 132) between 2pm and 7pm. Average trip value of \$85–\$89 represents a 3x premium over the fleet average. This single window accounts for the highest absolute revenue of any zone-hour combination in the dataset.

Impact: \$85–\$89 per trip vs \$28.86 fleet average

02

Anchor city fleet in East Harlem (Zone 70)

For drivers not targeting airport runs, Zone 70 is the strongest city zone — delivering \$60–\$70 per trip with a consistent 19–21% tip rate across all daylight hours. With 431K annual trips, volume is sufficient to sustain a full shift.

Impact: \$60–\$70 per trip, 19–21% tip rate, high volume

03

Restructure shift start times around peak windows

Shifts starting at 4am or 4pm consistently outperform all other windows by revenue per minute. The midday window (12pm–3pm) is the least efficient period in the dataset at \$1.76–\$1.82 per minute despite high trip volume — drivers working midday are leaving money on the table.

Impact: 4am–9am earns \$2.48–\$2.57/min vs \$1.76/min midday

04

Use LaGuardia as the round-trip efficiency play

LaGuardia (Zone 138) delivers \$55–\$59/trip across all hours with an 83% return-trip deadhead value versus JFK's 51%. For drivers who want consistent airport volume without long queue times, LaGuardia is the more efficient daily anchor.

Impact: \$55–\$59 per trip, 83% return value vs JFK's 51%

05

Avoid Saturday and midtown city-to-city

Saturday has the lowest average revenue (\$22.89/trip) and lowest tip rate (18%) of any day. Midtown city-to-city trips average \$19.84 — the weakest route type. Both represent significant opportunity cost against airport or East Harlem positioning.

Opportunity cost: –\$8–\$9 per trip vs weekly average

ROUTE TYPE ANALYSIS					
Route type	Annual trips	Avg rev / trip	Avg rev / min	Tip rate	Assessment
City to airport	2.5M	\$84.72	\$2.52	18.9%	Highest value
Airport pickup	9.1M	\$76.66	\$2.27	16.9%	High volume
City to city	103.5M	\$23.03	\$1.95	19.4%	Dominant volume

RISKS AND LIMITATIONS	
Cash tip gap	TLC data records card tips only. Cash-dominant zones may have higher actual driver take-home than data suggests.
Trip length trade-off	JFK trips average 43–57 minutes. High per-trip revenue may yield fewer total trips per shift depending on positioning.
Congestion pricing	NYC congestion pricing launched January 2025. Demand patterns are still shifting and zone-level data will evolve.
Data recency	Analysis covers 2023–2025. Tip rate decline (20.8% → 17.9%) may continue; monitor quarterly.

VISUAL ANALYSIS

REVENUE TRENDS — FARE RESTRUCTURE IMPACT



Exhibit 1. Average revenue per trip by year. The 2023 fare restructure created a +33% step change. Revenue has held within a \$0.25 band across 2023–2025.

HOURLY EFFICIENCY — REVENUE PER MINUTE

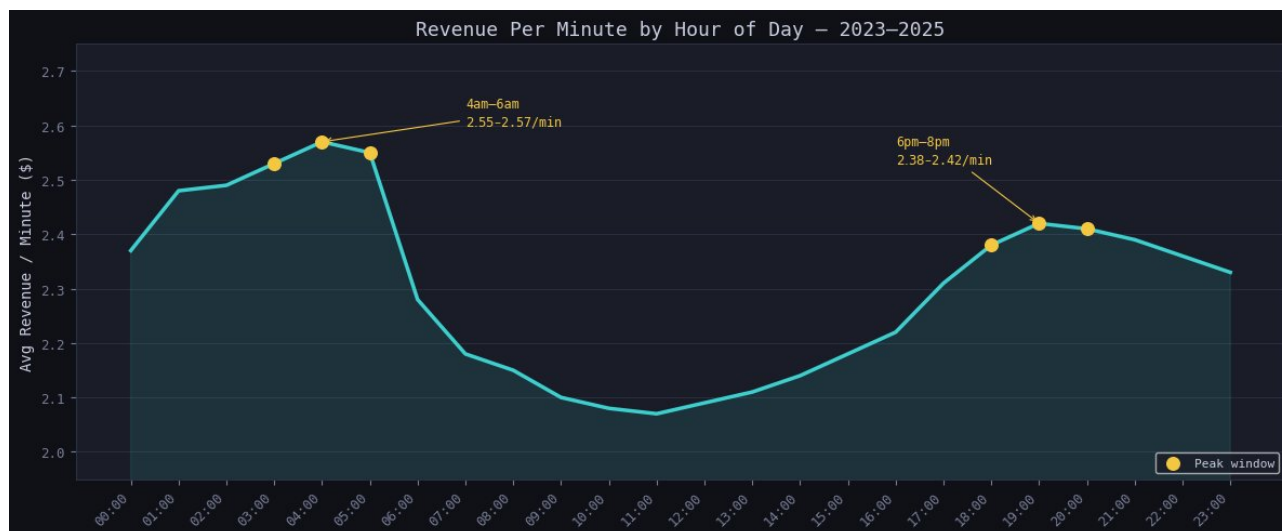


Exhibit 2. Revenue per minute by hour of day (2023–2025). 4am–6am and 6pm–8pm are peak windows. Midday 10am–1pm is the least efficient period.

VISUAL ANALYSIS (CONTINUED)

TIP RATE BY HOUR OF DAY



Exhibit 3. Tip percentage by hour. 5pm–7pm peaks at 21%+. Overnight hours generate higher gross revenue but lower tip rates.

TOP PICKUP ZONES BY AVERAGE REVENUE

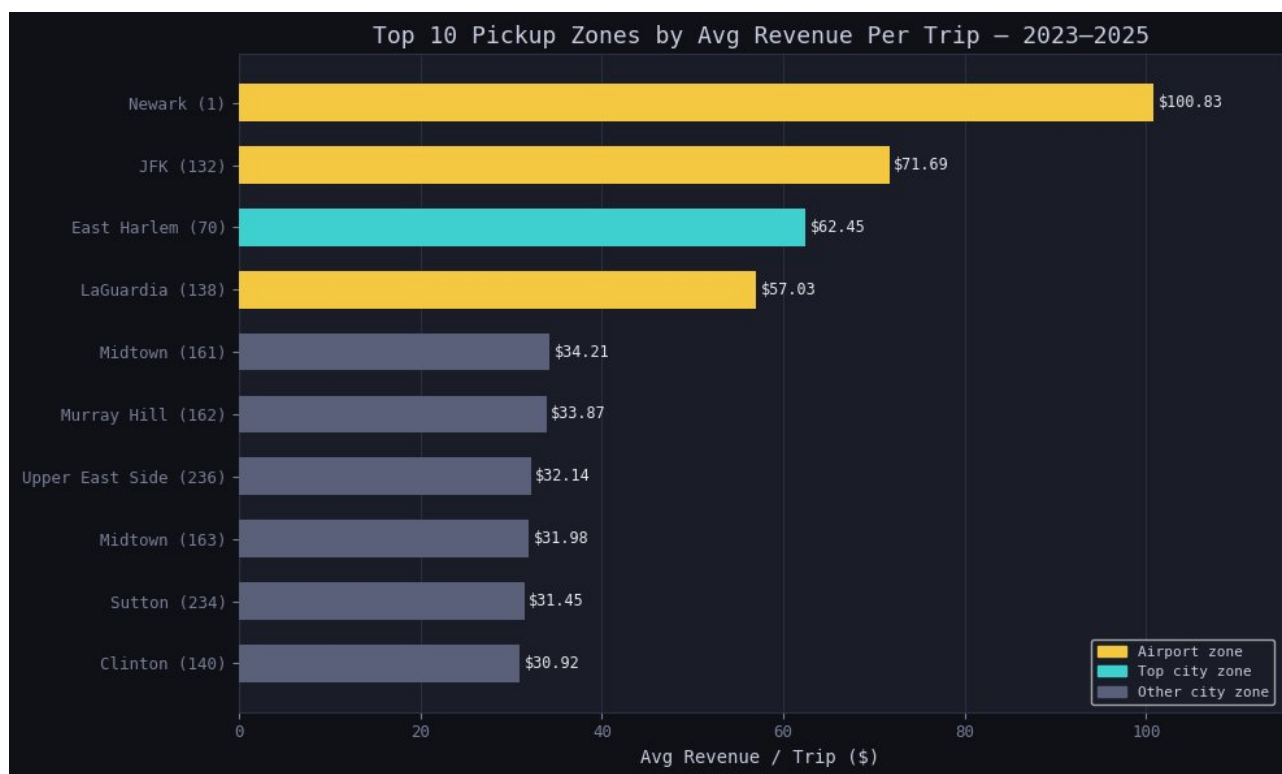


Exhibit 4. Top 10 pickup zones by avg revenue per trip (2023–2025). Airport zones (gold) operate in a different revenue tier. East Harlem (Zone 70) is the only city zone that competes.

VISUAL ANALYSIS (CONTINUED)

ROUTE TYPE ANALYSIS

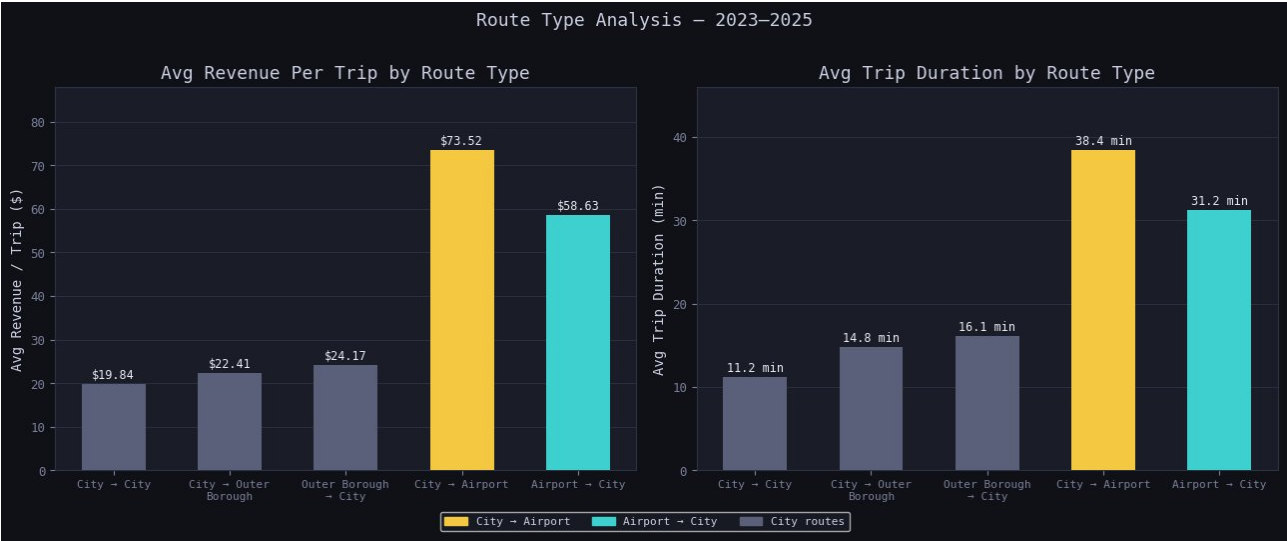


Exhibit 5. Revenue per trip and duration by route type. City-to-airport generates 3.7× the revenue of city-to-city trips.

ZONE × HOUR REVENUE HEATMAP

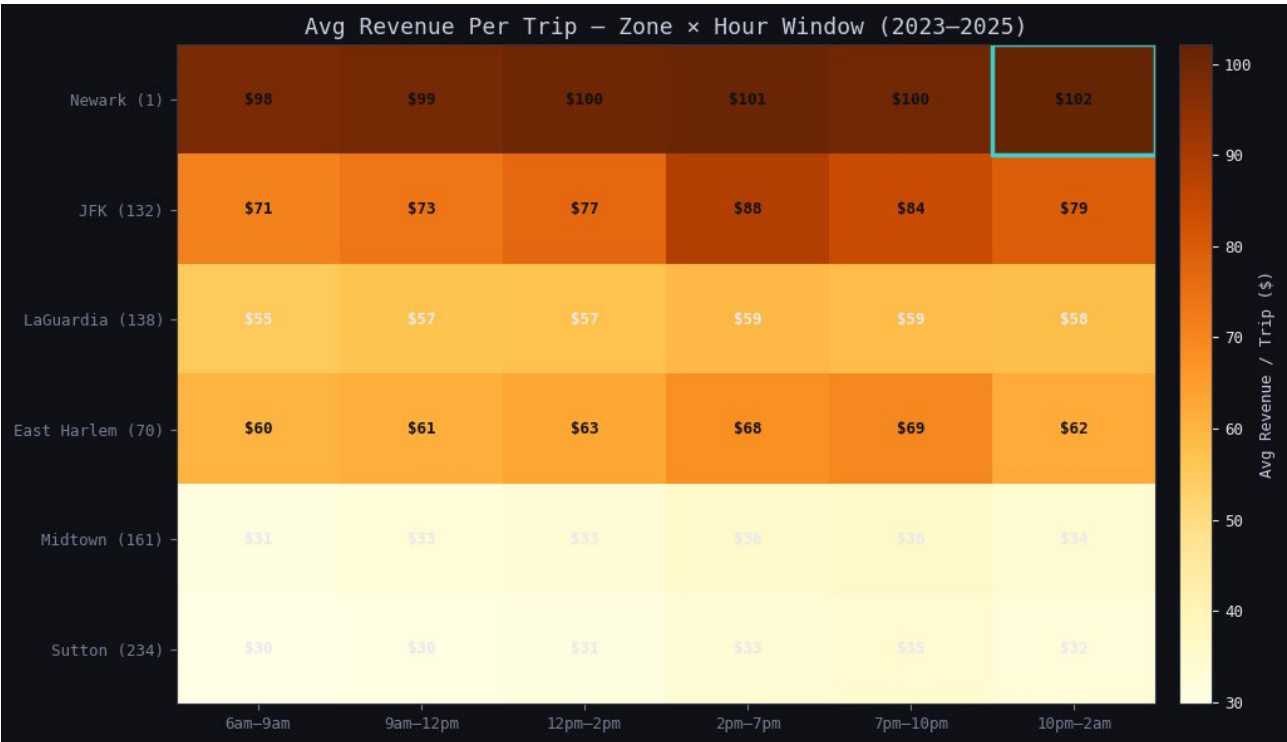


Exhibit 6. Average revenue per trip by zone and hour window (2023–2025). JFK 2pm–7pm is the single highest-value actionable combination in the dataset.

FLEET PRIORITY MATRIX

Summary reference for fleet managers. All figures based on 2023–2025 post-restructure data. Priority reflects combination of revenue per trip, revenue per minute, and trip volume.

Zone / Window	Avg Rev / Trip	Rev / Min	Tip Rate	Volume	Priority
JFK (132) — 2pm to 7pm	\$84–\$89	\$2.57	19.2%	High	Primary
LaGuardia (138) — Full day	\$55–\$59	\$2.45	19.8%	High	Primary
East Harlem (70) — 7pm to 10pm	\$69	\$2.98	21.1%	Medium	Secondary
Any zone — 4am to 6am	\$65+	\$2.55+	18.3%	Medium	Secondary
Any zone — 5pm to 7pm	\$45+	\$2.38+	21.2%	High	Secondary
JFK (132) — 10pm to 2am	\$79	\$2.75	18.9%	Low	Situational
LaGuardia — Return (airport→city)	\$48–\$52	\$2.31	19.4%	High	Situational
Midtown city-to-city	\$19–\$34	\$2.10	19.5%	High	Avoid
Saturday full day	\$22–\$25	\$1.98	18.0%	Medium	Avoid

Data source: NYC TLC Yellow Taxi Trip Records, 2019 and 2022–2025 (59 parquet files, 3.67 GB). Analysis based on 237.7M cleaned trips after removal of 10.4M rows (4.2%) flagged by data quality rules. Revenue figures reflect total_amount including all surcharges and fees. Tip figures reflect card tips only — cash tips not captured in source data.